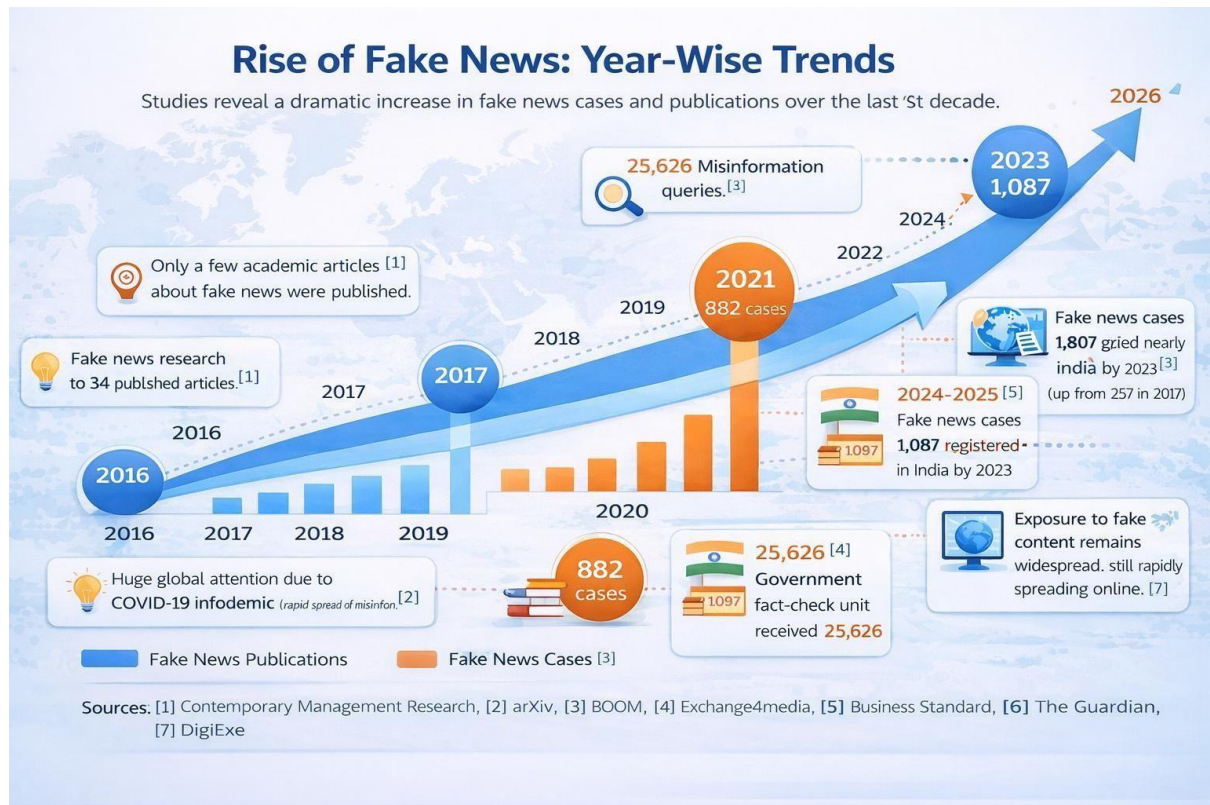


Year Wise Fake News Statistics



The graph illustrates the steady and significant growth in fake news publications and reported misinformation cases over the past decade. Early research indicates that prior to 2016, only a limited number of academic studies addressed the issue of fake news [1]. However, scholarly interest increased markedly between 2016 and 2019, with a noticeable rise in research publications examining misinformation and its societal impact [1], [2].

A substantial surge in fake news dissemination occurred during the COVID-19 pandemic, often described as an “infodemic,” during which misinformation spread rapidly across digital and social media platforms [2]. Between 2020 and 2021, reported fake news cases rose considerably, reaching 882 cases in 2021 alone [3]. In India, the number of registered fake news cases grew significantly, with 1,087 cases reported by 2023 [3], [5].

Furthermore, government fact-checking units received 25,626 misinformation-related queries, underscoring the magnitude and seriousness of the issue [4]. Additional reports indicate that exposure to fake content remains widespread and continues to proliferate rapidly in the online environment [6], [7].

Overall, the data highlights a consistent and concerning upward trend in both fake news publications and misinformation cases worldwide, reinforcing the urgent need for advanced automated detection systems and robust fact-verification mechanisms.

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